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FROM FOREIGN OFFICE TO WASHINGTON

Cypher/OTP.

FOREIGN OFFICE AND WHITEHALL
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FC1052/1966

No: 5904
December 1, 1954.

D: 12.53 p.m. December 1, 1954.

EMERGENCY
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Addressed to Washington telegram No: 5904 of December 1

Repeated for information to: U.K.Del. New York.
U.K.H.C. Wellington.
U.K.H.C. New Delhi.

Your telegram No: 2575 [of November 30] Quemoy and Formosa.

Following is line we propose to take when statement is published.

Begins:

This treaty is a matter entirely between the two parties. Conversations about it have been going on for a long time. We have not been consulted about the treaty nor seen its text. We have, however, been generally informed and are in contact all the time with the United States Government about the general situation in the Far East.

2. We have urged the importance of stopping the fighting and preventing further outbreaks. The Americans are aware of the dangers of the situation in that respect and we have been assured, and the statement itself confirms, that the treaty is purely defensive. We are satisfied that its object is to place relations between the United States Government and the Nationalist Chinese on such a basis as will result in a closer degree of consultation.

3. Her Majesty's Government's policy towards the islands off the Chinese coast has been to urge on all concerned the dangers of fighting, the importance of lowering tension and of avoiding precipitate action.

4. If we are asked about Her Majesty's Government's views on the future of Formosa itself we shall refer to the Prime Minister's statement of July 14 that he did not see anything in the conduct of China which has yet happened which should lead the American Government to deliver Formosa to Communist China.

5. We.....

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5. We shall refuse to be drawn on suggestions about United Nations trusteeship or neutralization and shall say that action on these lines must be acceptable to the parties immediately concerned who must be consulted.

Ends.

JJJJJ